Chain-of-Custody Form: Digital Evidence

How to complete this form

- Use one form per evidence item.
- Write in ink. Leave no field blank: write N/A if a field does not apply.
- Correct mistakes with a single line through the error, then add your initials and the time. Never erase or use correction fluid.
- Write every time with its time zone, for example 2026-10-14 10:42 IST (UTC+05:30).
- Never write passwords or encryption recovery keys on this form. Record only where they are held.

A. Case information

Case / incident reference		**Organisation / department**	
Incident lead (name, role, contact)		**Authorised by (name, role)**	
Date and time authorised (with time zone)			

B. Evidence item description

Evidence item number (e.g. E1)		**Item type and description**	
Make / model		**Serial number**	
Asset tag / other identifiers		**Colour, condition, visible damage**	
Accessories packaged with item		**Bag / seal number(s)**	
Power state when found (on / off / sleep)		**Power state when packaged**	
Encryption status (as reported) and location of recovery key			

C. Collection

Collected by (name, role)		**Signature**	
Date and time collected (with time zone)		**Location collected (building, room, desk)**	
Photograph references			
Notes (e.g. reported user actions, deviations)			

D. Transfer log

Record every hand-off. If the seal is broken (e.g. for imaging), record who broke it, when and why, and the new seal number.

#	Date and time (TZ)	Released by (name and signature)	Received by (name and signature)	Purpose of transfer	Seal no., intact? (Y/N)	Hash verified? (Y/N/N/A)	Location after transfer
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							

E. Hash record

Use SHA-256. Record MD5 or SHA-1 only in addition, if a tool requires it. Never run hashing tools on a live suspect device.

#	Item / file hashed	Algorithm	Hash value	Computed by	Date and time (TZ)	Tool and version
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						

F. Final disposition

Outcome (Returned to owner / Retained / Sanitised and disposed / Other)			
Details (e.g. returned to whom, sanitisation method)			
Authorised by (name, role, signature)		**Witness (name, signature)**	
Date and time (with time zone)			